

The first All India Backward Classes Commission was appointed by the President of India on 29th January 1953, which was formally inaugurated on the 18th of March 1953. The first chairman of the commission was Kaka Saheb Kalelkar. Dattatreya Balkrushna Kalelkar (1 Dec 1885-21 Aug 1981) Popularly known as Kaka Kalelkar, was an Indian independence activist, social reformer and journalist. He was a major follower of the philosophy and methods of Mahatma Gandhi. Kalelkar was born in Satara (Maharashtra). He was appointed as a member of Rajya Sabha from 1952 to 1964. He presided Gujarati Sahitya Parishad in 1959. He established Gandhi Vidyapith, Vedchhi in 1967 and served as its vice-chancellor. Mahatma Gandhi called him Savai Gujarati (a quarter more than a Gujarati).

29. Which one of the following is correctly matched?

Constitutional Body	Constitutional Article
(a) Election Commission	– 165
(b) National Commission For Scheduled Castes	– 148
(c) Finance Commission	– 263
(d) National Commission For Backward Classes	– 340

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (*)

In the Constitution of India under Article 324 the 'Election Commission gets a mention, under Article 338 'National Commission for Scheduled Castes' is mentioned, under Article 280 the Finance Commission is mentioned and under Article 338B [added through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018] National Commission for Backward Classes is mentioned. Hence, No pair of constitutional bodies and their constitutional Articles in the question is correctly matched. The Article 340 of the Constitution provides for the Appointment of a Commission to investigate the conditions of backward classes. Possibly, on the same ground the answer key issued by the U.P.P.S.C. provides the option (d) as the correct answer.

Miscellaneous

1. U.N.O. was founded in -

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| (a) 1944 | (b) 1945 |
| (c) 1946 | (d) 1947 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

United Nations is an international organization founded in 1945. The draft of United Nations Charter was finalized in a conference held in San Francisco during April to June, 1945. On 26 June, 1945, 50 nations signed the Charter. Representative of Poland was not present at San Francisco

and ratified the Charter on 16 October, 1945, as the 51st member of the United Nations. This organization came into being on 24 October, 1945 and this date is observed as the 'United Nations Day.'

2. When is the 'United Nations Day' observed?

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| (a) 27 th October | (b) 24 th October |
| (c) 26 th October | (d) 15 th October |

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The number of permanent members in the United Nations Security Council is :

- | | | | |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| (a) 6 | (b) 5 | (c) 4 | (d) 3 |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is one of the six principal organs of the United Nations and is charged with the maintenance of peace and security. The Security Council consist of fifteen (15) members, including 5 permanent members (USA, France, China, UK (Britain and Russia) and 10 non-permanent members. The 10 non-permanent members are elected on a regional basis by United Nations for a term of 2 years.

4. Which of the following is not a permanent member of the U.N. Security Council?

- | | |
|-------------------|------------|
| (a) Germany | (b) France |
| (c) Great Britain | (d) China |

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Which of the following countries was NOT elected in June 2020 as a non-permanent member of United Nations Security Council for the year 2021-22?

- | | |
|-------------|------------|
| (a) Ireland | (b) Norway |
| (c) Mexico | (d) Canada |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

India began its two-year tenure as a non-permanent member of the United Nations Security Council from January 1, 2021. India will sit in the 15 nation UNSC for the 2021-22 term as a non-Permanent member. Apart from India Ireland, Kenya, Mexico and Norway have also been elected as a non-permanent member for the same term.

6. In April 2024, how many members of the UN Security Council either rejected or abstained from voting for the proposal to allow Palestine to become a full member of the UN?

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| (a) 6 | (b) 2 |
| (c) 3 | (d) 5 |

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

In April, 2024, the United Nations Security Council rejected a proposal regarding the full membership of Palestine in the United Nations. The United States of America vetoed this proposal, while Switzerland and United Kingdom abstained from voting. In this way, three members either abstained or casted negative votes.

7. According to United Nations Charter which of the following statements is not true regarding exercise of veto power in the Security Council?

- For Security Council decision on every procedural matter there should be 9 affirmative votes of its members including the 5 votes of five permanent members.
- Every permanent member of Security Council may by use of Veto Power, withhold acceptance on any decision.
- The word 'Veto' has been used under Article 27 of UN Charter so that any permanent member may stop a resolution going to be passed with a majority.
- Any member of Security Council may use Veto Power to stop a resolution going to be passed with a majority.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

In Security Council, there are five permanent members (United States, France, China, Britain, and Russia) who are authorized to exercise veto power to withhold any resolution going to be passed with a majority. Only the permanent members have veto power.

8. The demand for democratisation of U.N.O. is mainly related to -

- General Assembly
- Economic and social council
- Security Council
- Trustship Council

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The demand for the democratisation of UNO is mainly related to security council. Security council has five permanent member (USA, UK, China, Russia, France) only. So countries like India, Brazil, South Africa etc are demanding for democratisation of security council.

9. With reference to the UN peacekeeping operations, consider the following statements:

- UN peacekeepers can use force only for their self-defence.
- Peacekeeping operations can only be withdrawn by a resolution by the UN Security Council.
- USA is the largest budget contributor to the UN peacekeeping operations.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 and 2 only
- 2 and 3 only

- 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3
- None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2022

Ans. (b)

Statement 1 is false, the United Nations Peace-keeper can use force in self-defense as well as in 'Defense of the Mandates also. Remaining statements 2 and 3 are true. USA is the largest budget contributor to the UN peacekeeping operations which is around 28% in UN peacekeeping operation in year 2020-21.

10. With reference to the "United Nations Credentials Committee", consider the following statements:

- It is a committee set up by the UN Security Council and works under its supervision.
- It traditionally meets in March, June and September every year.
- It assesses the credentials of all UN members before submitting a report to the General Assembly for approval.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 3 only
- 1 and 3
- 2 and 3
- 1 and 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

A United Nations Credentials Committee is appointed at the beginning of each regular session of the General assembly. It consists of nine (9) members who are appointed by the General Assembly on proposal of the president. Usually the committee meets in November. It assess the credentials of all UN members before submitting a report to general assembly for approval. Thus only (3) statement is correct.

11. With reference to the United Nations General Assembly, consider the following statements:

- The UN General Assembly can grant observer status to the non-member States.
- Inter-governmental organisations can seek observer status in the UN General Assembly.
- Permanent Observers in the UN General Assembly can maintain missions at the UN headquarters.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- 1 and 2 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

The General Assembly can grant observer status to non-member states. Inter-governmental organisations can seek observer status in UN General Assembly. Permanent observers in UN General Assembly can maintain missions at the UN headquarters. The status of a permanent observer is based purely on practise, and there is no provision for it in

United Nations Charter. This practise dates from 1946, when the Secretary-General accepted the designation of the swiss Government as a permanent observer to United Nations.

12. United Nations has identified few characteristics of Good Governance. Which one of the followings is not one of those characteristics?

- (a) Participation (b) Accountability
(c) Government Legitimacy (d) Transparency

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

Good governance has 8 major characteristics as per United Nations. It includes Participation, Rule of law, Transparency, Responsiveness, Consensus Oriented, Equality and Inclusiveness, Effectiveness and Efficiency, and Accountability.

13. Which one is not true for good governance?

- (a) Transparency and Responsiveness
(b) Equity and Inclusiveness
(c) Religiosity and Emotionality
(d) Participation and Rule of law

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. Who is the present Secretary General of the United Nations Organization?

- (a) Ban Ki Moon (b) Antonio Guterres
(c) Kofi Annan (d) Kurt Waldheim

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Antonio Guterres is the present Secretary-General of the United Nations Organisation.

15. Which one of the following is about Ruchira Kamboj, who was the first woman to become the Indian Ambassador to the United Nations who retired recently, is true ?

- (a) She was a member of the NITI Ayog
(b) She was a member of Indian Council of World Affairs
(c) She held the position of Permanent Representative of India to UNESCO Paris
(d) She was the first woman Indian Ambassador to USA

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

Ruchira Kamboj served as India's permanent representative to the United Nations from August 2022 to May 2024. She was the first woman to become India's ambassador to the United Nations. She held the position of India's permanent representative to the UNESCO Paris from April 2014 to July 2017. She also served as the Chairperson of the United Nations Security Council Advisory Committee in December 2022, making her the first Indian woman to hold that position.

16. Who among the following has been the first African U.N. Secretary General?

- (a) Ban Ki Moon (b) Javier Perez De Cuellar
(c) Boutros-Boutros Ghali (d) U-Thant

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The first African UN Secretary General was Boutros-Boutros Ghali. He worked as the 6th UN Secretary-General from 1 January, 1992 to 31 December, 1996. He was egyptian politician and diplomat. The second African Secretary General was Kofi Annan. Current secretary General of United Nations is Antonio Guterres, a Portuguese politician and diplomat.

17. Which U.N. Secretary General served for the longest period?

- (a) Trygve Lie (b) Kurt Waldheim
(c) Xavier Peres De Cuillar (d) U. Thant

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006 (*)

Ans. (d)

Third Secretary General of United Nations U. Thant served for the longest period (1961-1971). Tenure of all Secretary Generals is given below.

1. Trygve Lie (Norway) - 2 February, 1946-10 November, 1952
2. Dag Hammarskjold (Sweden) - 10 April, 1953-18 September, 1961
3. U. Thant (Burma) - 3 November, 1961-31 December, 1971
4. Kurt Waldheim (Austria) - 1 January, 1972-31 December, 1981
5. Javier Perez de cuellar (Peru) - 1 January, 1982- 31 December 1991
6. Boutros-Boutros Ghali (Egypt) - 1 January, 1992- 31 December, 1996
7. Kofi Annan (Ghana) - 1 January, 1997- 31 December, 2006
8. Ban Ki Moon (South Korea) - 1 January, 2007- 31 December, 2016.
9. Antonio Guterres (Portugal) - 1 January, 2017 – incumbent.

18. Who was the permanent Representative of India to the UN before Syed Akbaruddin?

- (a) Hardeep Singh Puri
(b) Shashi Tharoor
(c) Asoke Kumar Mukerji
(d) Nirupam Sen
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Asoke Kumar Mukerji was the permanent representative of India to the UN before Syed Akbaruddin. Ruchira Kamboj was the permanent representative of India since August 2022- to may 2024, She was the first woman on this post. Parvathaneni Harish is the current permanent representative of India to UN, since September, 2024.

19. World's main languages are –

- (1) Chinese (2) English
(3) Hindi (4) Spanish

Which one of the given languages is not an official language of United Nations, choose correct answer using code below –

Code:

- (a) Chinese (b) English
(c) Hindi (d) Spanish

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

Hindi is not an official language of United Nations. English and French are used as a working language while the six official languages are English, French, Spanish, Arabic, Chinese and Russian.

20. Which are the official languages of the U.N.O.?

- (a) English, French, and Russian
(b) English, French, German, and Russian
(c) English, French, Russian, Chinese and Hindi
(d) English, French, Chinese, Russian, Arabic and Spanish

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

21. Consider the following statements :

- 21st February is declared to be the International Mother Language Day by UNICEF.
- The demand that Bangla has to be one of the national languages was raised in the Constituent Assembly of Pakistan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

International Mother Language Day was proclaimed by the General Conference of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) (not by UNICEF) in November 1999. The UN General Assembly welcomed the proclamation of the day in its resolution of 2002. Ekushe February, or simply "Ekushe", which is "The 21st" in Bangla, commemorates the day in 1952 when students of the University of Dhaka launched a nationwide protest against the imposition of Urdu on the people of what was then East Pakistan.

22. The UN General Assembly has adopted an India-sponsored resolution on multilingualism. Which language is mentioned in that for the first time?

- (a) Urdu (b) Sanskrit

- (c) Bengali (d) Hindi

- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2022

Ans. (e)

The India-sponsored resolution on multilingualism was adopted by the United Nations General Assembly in June 2022, in which Hindi, Urdu and Bengali Languages were mentioned for the first time.

23. Which of the following languages is spoken by maximum number of persons in the world?

- (a) Bengali (b) French
(c) Japanese (d) Portuguese

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003 (*)

Ans. (b)

The languages spoken by maximum number of people in the world are as follows:

- | | | |
|-----------------------|---|--------------|
| (i) English | - | 1268 million |
| (ii) Mandarin Chinese | - | 1120 million |
| (iii) Hindi | - | 637 million |
| (iv) Spanish | - | 538 million |
| (v) French | - | 277 million |
| (vi) Standard Arabic | - | 274 million |
| (vii) Russian | - | 258 million |
| (viii) Portuguese | - | 252 million |
| (ix) Bengali | - | 265 million |
| (x) Standard German | - | 132 million |
| (xi) Japanese | - | 126 million |

So, among the given options, the correct answer is option (b).

24. Who among the following has been the first person to deliver his speech in Hindi at U.N.O.?

- (a) Swami Vivekananda (b) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(c) Atal Bihari Vajpayee (d) None of the above

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Atal Bihari Vajpayee is the first Indian to deliver a speech in Hindi at United Nations Assembly. He delivered the speech on 4 October, 1977 as Foreign Minister. During the 69th opening ceremony of United Nations on 27th September, 2014, Prime Minister Narendra Modi delivered his speech in Hindi. By doing this, he became the second Prime Minister, and third Indian leader to do so. It is noteworthy that in the Year 1988, P.V. Narashima Rao (the then Foreign Minister) addressed the United Nations session in Hindi.

25. Which one of the following countries is not a member of U.N.O.?

- (a) Libya (b) Iraq
(c) Switzerland (d) Namibia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (*)

Switzerland was not a member of the United Nations when this question was asked in 1996. Afterwards, on 10 September, 2002 it became UN member. Iraq (1945), Namibia (1990) and Libya (1955) were already the members of United Nations before 1996.

26. Which one of the following is the World's newest country?

- (a) Eritrea (b) Ethiopia
(c) Congo (d) South Sudan

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

On 9 July, 2011 South Sudan was created as the newest and 193rd Country of the world. It's current capital is Juba.

27. The headquarters of International Court of Justice is situated at:

- (a) Hague (b) New York
(c) Geneva (d) Paris

**53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994**

Ans. (a)

International Court of Justice was established in June, 1945. It is headquartered at Hague (The Netherlands).

28. Prior to Shri R. N. Pathak two Indian Judges elected to the International Court of Justice were -

- (a) H. J. Kania and B. N. Rau
(b) J. C. Saha and A.N. Ray
(c) B. N. Rau and Nagendra Singh
(d) Nagendra Singh and A. N. Ray

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The Judges elected to the International Court of Justice from India are Benegal Narsingh Rau (1952-1953), Nagendra Singh (1973-1988), Raghunandan Pathak (1989-1991) and at present, Dalveer Bhandari (2012-2018). On 20 November, 2017 Judge Dalveer Bhandari was re-elected by the United Nations General Assembly and United Nations Security Council as a member of the International Court of Justice for a 9 year (2018-2027) term.

29. In Which year the International Labour Organisation was established?

- (a) 1919 (b) 1920
(c) 1921 (d) 1922

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The International Labour Organisation was established in 1919. It was created as part of the Treaty of Versailles. It is a specialised agency of U.N. and Its headquarters is located in Geneva.

30. Consider the following statements :

1. The United Nations Convention against Corruption (UNCAC) has a 'Protocol against the Smuggling of Migrants by Land, Sea and Air'.

2. The UNCAC is the ever-first legally binding global anti-corruption instrument.

3. A highlight of the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organized Crime (UNTOC) is the inclusion of a specific chapter aimed at returning assets to their rightful owners from whom they had been taken illicitly.

4. The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) is mandated by its member States to assist in the implementation of both UNCAC and UNTOC. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The protocol against the smuggling of migrants by land, sea and air, it comes under the United Nations Convention against Transnational organized Crime (UNTOC). Hence, statement 1 is incorrect.

The United Nations Convention against corruption (UNCAC) is the only legally binding universal anti-corruption instrument. Hence, statement 2 is correct.

Returning Assets to their rightful owners from whom they had been taken illicitly, is included under the United Nations Convention Against Corruption. Hence option 3 is incorrect. The United Nations office on Drug and Crime (UNODC) is mandated by its member states to assists in the implementation of both conventions UNCAC and UNTOC. Hence option 4 is correct. So, the correct answer is option (c).

31. "Rule of law Index" is released by which of the following?

- (a) Amnesty International
(b) International Court of Justice
(c) The Office of UN Commissioner for Human Rights
(d) World Justice Project

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The world Justice project releases 'Rule of Law Index'. Measuring the rule of law since 2008 the index has been at the forefront of creating social change through information.

32. Which one is not related to United Nations?

- (a) General Assembly
(b) Amnesty International
(c) International Court of Justice
(d) Trusteeship Council

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

General Assembly, International Court of Justice and Trusteeship Council are the three out of six principal organs of United Nations, but Amnesty International is not related to UN. It is a non-governmental organization with over 7 million members focussed on Human Rights and defending those who are denied justice or freedom.

33. Amnesty International is –

- (a) An agency of the United Nations to help refugees of civil wars.
- (b) A Global Human Rights Movement.
- (c) A non-governmental voluntary organization to help extremely poor people.
- (d) An inter-governmental agency to cater to medical emergencies in war-ravaged regions.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Amnesty International is a global movement of more than 7 million people in over 150 countries and territories who campaign to end abuses of Human Rights. It was founded in 1961 by British lawyer Peter Benenson. Its headquarter is in London.

34. Amnesty International is an organization associated with

- (a) Protection of women's rights
- (b) Protection of human rights
- (c) Abolition of untouchability
- (d) None of the above

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

35. 'Doctors Without Borders (Medecins Sans Frontieres),' often in the news, is

- (a) A division of World Health Organization
- (b) A non-governmental international organization
- (c) An inter-governmental agency sponsored by the European Union
- (d) A specialized agency of the United Nations

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Doctors without Borders (Medecins Sans Frontieres) is an international humanitarian-aid non-governmental organization. It was founded in France. In 2015, over 30,000 local doctors, nurses, medical practitioners, etc. provided medical aid in over 70 countries. In 1999, it won Noble Peace Prize.

36. How many countries of the World have adopted Compulsory Voting System?

- (a) 32
- (b) 25
- (c) 24
- (d) 22

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (*)

According to the 255th report of law commission in March 2015, 28 countries around the world have adopted Compulsory Voting System often starting at the Age of 18.

37. Consider the following statements regarding the 'White House' :

- 1. The address of the White House is 1800 Pennsylvania Avenue.
- 2. It is the official residence and workplace of the President of USA.
- 3. On November 1, 1800, John Adams became the first President to take residence in the building.
- 4. It is a symbol of American Democracy.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- (a) 1, 3 and 4
- (b) Only 2 and 3
- (c) Only 3 and 4
- (d) 2, 3 and 4

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The White House is the official residence and workplace of the American President. Its foundation - stone was laid in the year 1792. In the year 1800 its construction was almost complete. On 1st November, 1800 the then President John Adams became the first American President to dwell in it. Its official address is 1600 Pennsylvania Avenue in Washington D.C. (capital of USA). The White House is recognised as the symbol of American Democracy, because the president is an integral part of the American Constitution.

38. The Electoral College for the United States Presidential Election is comprised of -

- (a) Members of United State Congress
- (b) Members of House of Representative
- (c) Members of Senate
- (d) None of them

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The President and Vice President of America are not elected directly by the people instead, they are chosen by "electors" through a process called the Electoral College.

39. Where does the first primary take place in the election of U.S. President -

- (a) New York
- (b) New Hampshire
- (c) Massachusetts
- (d) California

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

The first primary in the election of US President takes place in New Hampshire and Iowa states. The elections for first primary are held about a year ahead of the presidential elections. Conventionally the process of election for the President starts from here. The electoral college is the mechanism established by the United States Constitution for the indirect election of the President of the United States.

40. Where was, the concept of written Constitution, born?

- (a) France (b) United States of America
(c) Britain (d) Switzerland

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

The concept of a written Constitution first came in to existence in the United States of America.

41. Larry Pressler is associated with -

- (a) Ending of U.S. sanctions on military assistance to Pakistan.
(b) To strengthen cordial relations between U.S and Pakistan.
(c) Criticizing the proposed Military help to Pakistan by the Clinton-Administration.
(d) Announcement of candidate for Presidential elections.

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Larry Pressler was a U.S Senator who brought up Pressler Amendment in 1986, to link US assistance with nuclear non-proliferation. He criticized US assistance to Pakistan by the Clinton administration on the grounds of Pakistan's involvement in nuclear proliferation.

42. Match the following:

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. Pressler Amendments | 1. Bangladesh |
| B. Chakma Refugees | 2. Gorbachev |
| C. Perestroika | 3. Agreement between Israel and P.L.O. |
| D. 13th September, 1993 | 4. Linking American assistance and with development of nuclear capacity |

Code:

- | | | | | |
|-----|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (b) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (c) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The 'Pressler Amendments' linked American aid to the development of nuclear capacity. 'Chakma Refugees' are Bangladeshi refugees in India. Perestroika was the economic policy of the former and the last President of the Soviet Union Mikhail Gorbachev. When in May, 1948, the State of Israel was proclaimed, and five Arab Nations attacked in support of the Palestinian Arabs, since then a, bloody animosity developed and decades passed in fighting. A historic peace accord was signed between Israel and PLO on September 13, 1993.

43. 'Pivot to Asia' is the strategy of the foreign policy of

- (a) India (b) Japan

(c) China

(d) U.S.A.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Pivot to Asia' is the strategy of the foreign policy of the United States of America (U.S.A.).

44. C.I.A. is the intelligence agency of -

- (a) Russia (b) England
(c) India (d) U.S.A.

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

C.I.A. (Central Intelligence Agency) is a civilian foreign intelligence service of the United States of America.

45. Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) is part of which of the following?

- (a) Ministry of Home Affairs
(b) Cabinet Secretariat
(c) The Prime Minister's Office
(d) Ministry of External Affairs

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Research and Analysis wing is a foreign intelligence agency of India. It was constituted on 21 September, 1968 under the tenure of former Prime Minister Late Mrs Indira Gandhi. It functions under Cabinet secretariat.

46. What is "Mossad"?

- (a) A Committee of Maulanas
(b) Israel's intelligence agency
(c) Parliament of Iran
(d) Key of Morse Code

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Mossad is the National Intelligence Agency of Israel. Mossad is responsible for intelligence collection, covert operations, and counterterrorism.

47. What does ISI stand for?

- (a) Inter-Services Intelligence
(b) Inter-State Intelligence
(c) India Security International
(d) None of the above

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

ISI stands for Inter-Services Intelligence. It is the premier military-operated intelligence agency of Pakistan.

48. What is Fourth Estate?

- (a) The twelfth player in a cricket team
(b) A mode of transport in addition to road, rail and air

- (c) A large agricultural cooperative organization
(d) Press

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The 'Press' plays an important role in nation-building. Hence it is known as the 'Fourth Estate of democracy.'

49. Which of the following is the Centre of British News Papers –

- (a) Wall Street (b) Farst Street
(c) Fleet Street (d) Press Street

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

The Fleet Street in Central London, England, was the location of many newspaper offices. Till 1980, many British newspapers published from the Fleet Street. The last Major newspaper office removed from the Fleet Street was the Office of Reuters News Agency in 2005.

50. Consider the following statements –

1. The Parliament of Russia is called Federal Assembly.
2. The Council of the Federation is the Lower House of the Russian Parliament.
3. The name of the Upper House of the Russian Parliament is State Duma.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

The Parliament of Russia is called, 'Federal Assembly.' The Lower House of the Russian Parliament is known as 'Duma,' while the Upper House is called Council of the Federation.' Therefore, in the given statements only statement (1) is correct.

51. The Parliament of Japan is known as –

- (a) Riksdag (b) Diet
(c) Cortez (d) Sejim

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

'Diet' also called as 'Imperial Diet' is the National Legislature of Japan. Japan has a Parliamentary System of Government like Britain and Canada. Similarly Riksdag–Sweden, Cortez–Spain and Sejim is the parliament of Poland.

52. Chinese Parliament is known as –

- (a) National Assembly
(b) National People's Congress
(c) The National Parliament of China
(d) The House of Democracy of China

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

Chinese Parliament is known as the National People's Congress (NPC). It has 2977 members presently and is the biggest Parliament in the world. However in practice, it is just a rubber-stamp Legislature which approves the decisions of the Communist Party of China.

53. The political leadership of which country is known as 'Princeling'?

- (a) Japan (b) Thailand
(c) China (d) Belgium

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The Princelings, meaning the Party's crown Princes, are the descendants of prominent and influential senior communist officials in the People's Republic of China.

54. Tass is the news agency of –

- (a) Germany (b) France
(c) Russia (d) Iran

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

TASS was the official news agency of the Soviet Union until 1991. After the disintegration of the Soviet Union in 1991, a new name was given to the Russian news agency as ITAR-TASS, known as a 'Information Telegraph Agency of Russia-Telegraph Agency of the Soviet Union' since 1992.

55. What is the name of China's News Agency?

- (a) China News (b) China Times
(c) New China News Agency (d) New China Report

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

'New China News Agency' is the news agency of China.

56. 'Dawn' is a newspaper of which of the following countries?

- (a) China (b) U.S.A
(c) U.K (d) Pakistan

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

Dawn is a leading English newspaper of Pakistan. It was founded by Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah in Delhi, India, on 26 October, 1941.

57. Government Report of which of the following countries is known as 'Yellow Book'?

- (a) France (b) Britain
(c) Italy (d) Germany

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Yellow Book is the government report of the French Government.

58. Consider the following statements –

1. The Commonwealth has no charter, treaty or constitution.
2. All the territories/countries once under the British Empire (jurisdiction/rule/mandate) automatically joined the Commonwealth as its members.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

The Commonwealth has no charter, treaty or constitution. However, all the territories/countries which were once under the British Empire did not become members of Commonwealth automatically. A country willing to be a part of the commonwealth has to make a declaration for this. Among the former British empire, there are many countries like- Burma, Egypt, Kuwait and UAE etc. which never became member of the Commonwealth.

59. 'It is an agreement by free will to be terminated by free will.'

The above statement of Pt. Nehru refers to which of the following?

- (a) India's Association with the Commonwealth of Nations
(b) Treaty of Panchsheel
(c) Shimla Agreement
(d) None of the above

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

The above statement of Pt. Nehru refers to India's Association with the Commonwealth of Nations.

60. The first Indian Prime Minister who visited Afghanistan was –

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) I.K. Gujaral
(c) A. B. Vajpai (d) Man Mohan Singh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

The first Indian Prime Minister who visited Afghanistan was Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, in September, 1959, thereafter Indira Gandhi visited the country in 1976. Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Afghanistan on June 4, 2016.

61. The Indian Foreign Policy of Non-Alignment was initiated by –

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Mrs. Indira Gandhi
(c) Lal Bahadur Shastri (d) Morarji Desai

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

After taking over as interim Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru announced a foreign policy based on non-alignment which means 'to stay away from international power groups and to develop an independent policy.'

62. Which one of the following is not a principle of "Panchsheel"?

- (a) Non-alignment
(b) Peaceful Co-existence
(c) Mutual respect for each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty
(d) Mutual non-interference in each other's internal affairs

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Meaning of "Panchsheel" is the five rules of behaviour or conduct as given below.

- (i) Mutual respect for geo-regional integrity and sovereignty of each other,
(ii) Mutual non-aggression.
(iii) Non-interference in the internal matters of each other.
(iv) Mutual benefits and equality.
(v) Peaceful co-existence.

Non-alignment is not a principle of Panchsheel but the policy of non-alignment itself is based on the principles of Panchsheel.

63. Who was the Prime Minister of India when the basic principle of India's Nuclear Doctrine of 'No First Use' was adopted?

- (a) I.K. Gujaral (b) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(c) Manmohan Singh (d) Indira Gandhi

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Atal Bihari Vajpayee was the Prime Minister of India when the basic principle of India's Nuclear Doctrine of No First Use was adopted. After the 1998 nuclear test India also enunciated a doctrine of 'No first Use' of Nuclear Weapons. The doctrine was formally adopted in January, 2003.

64. The Six Points Formula proposal of India for South Asian Region was presented by which Prime Minister of India?

- (a) Manmohan Singh (b) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(c) Narendra Modi (d) Inder Kumar Gujral

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The Six Points Formula proposal of India for South Asian Region was presented by Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.

65. Which country has recently reaffirmed Arunachal Pradesh as an integral part of India?

- (a) USA (b) Australia

(c) Germany

(d) Russia

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

In July, 2023, the USA reiterated its opinion in this regard, that the Arunachal Pradesh is an integral part of India. Again, in March, 2024 the foreign ministry of US affirmed the Arunachal Pradesh as an Indian Region or part and contradicted the claim of China.

66. Minimum age for M.P. (Lower house) M.P. (Upper house) and President is

(a) 25, 30 and 35 (b) 25, 35 and 45

(c) 25, 30 and 30 (d) 25, 35 and 35

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

According to Article 58(1)(b) of the Constitution, the minimum age for the post of President is 35 years. As per Article 84(b), the minimum age for being a member of the Lok Sabha is 25 years, and for the Rajya Sabha, it is 30 years. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

67. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I

(Minimum

Qualification of Age)

List-II

(Office/Post)

A. 21 years

B. 25 years

C. 30 years

D. 35 years

1. President of India

2. Member of Panchayat

3. Member of State Legislative Assembly

4. Member of State Legislative Council

Codes:

A

B

C

D

(a) 2

3

4

1

(b) 1

2

4

3

(c) 2

1

3

4

(d) 4

1

2

3

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (a)

Correct match List-I with List-II–

List-I

List-II

21 years — Member of Panchayat

25 years — Member of State Legislative Assembly

30 years — Member of State Legislative Council

35 years — President of India

68. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below:

List-I

(Functionaries)

List-II

(Oaths or affirmations)

A. President of India

1. Secrecy of Information

Ans. (b)

B. Judges of Supreme Court

C. Members of Parliament

D. Ministers for the Union

Code :

A

B

C

D

(a) 3

4

1

2

(b) 4

3

2

1

(c) 3

4

2

1

(d) 4

3

1

2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The matched List-I and II is as follows:

President of India - Faith and Allegiance to the Constitution of India.

Judges of Supreme Court - Upholding the Constitution and Law.

Members of Parliament - Faithful Discharge of Duties.

Ministers for the Union - Secrecy of Information.

69. Meaning of Extra-Constitutional Right -

(a) That power which violates the limits of Constitution.

(b) A person who has got exceptional powers under the Constitution.

(c) That power which is not in accordance with the provisions of the Constitution.

(d) That official who has all the powers of the State during the proclamation of emergency.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Those rights which do not find mention in the provisions of the constitution are called extra-constitutional rights. For example, there was no constitutional provision for planning commission rather it was formed by a resolution of the Cabinet, still it exercised power in respect of Centre and the States.

70. Consider the following events :

1. The first democratically, elected communist party government formed in a State in India.

2. India's then largest bank, 'Imperial Bank of India'. was renamed 'State Bank of India'.

3. Air India was nationalised and became the national carrier.

4. Goa became a part of independent, India.

Which of the following is the correct chronological sequence of the above events?

(a) 4 – 1 – 2 – 3

(b) 3 – 2 – 1 – 4

(c) 4 – 2 – 1 – 3

(d) 3 – 1 – 2 – 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Air India was nationalised in 1953 and became the national carrier. In July, 1955 India then largest bank, Imperial bank of India, was renamed state bank of India. In April, 1957, the first democratically elected communist party government formed in a state in India. E.M.S. Namboodiripad popularly known as EMS became the first non-congress chief minister in Indian republic. Through 12 CAA, Goa became a part of independent India in 1962.

71. The powers of District Collector as a District Magistrate are:

- A. To maintain law and order
- B. Control over police
- C. To check passports of foreigners
- D. To control land revenue

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code:

- (a) A, C, D
- (b) A, B, D
- (c) A, B, C
- (d) B, C, D

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The power of the District Collector as District Magistrate includes:

The Maintenance of law and order in the district and to control the police department of his district and recommend the cases for passport and visa and take care of the movement of a foreigner in the district while the power to control the Land Revenue is exercised by him as a Collector. Thus, option (c) is correct.

72. Who among following has called the District Collector an 'Institutional Charisma'?

- (a) Rajni Kothari
- (b) P.R. Dubhashi
- (c) T.N. Chaturvedi
- (d) J.D. Shukla

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Rajni Kothari in his book 'Politics In India' called the District Collector an 'Institutional Charisma.'

73. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) The total number of Articles in the Constitution of India is 395.
- (b) Finance Commission is constituted under Article 280 of the Constitution of India.
- (c) Madam Cama was the first woman President of Indian National Congress,
- (d) 'Politics in India' is the pioneering research study of Rajni Kothari.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Annie Besant was the first woman Chairman of the Indian National Congress. She chaired the 32nd session held in 1917 in Kolkata. While Madam Cama was famous for hoisting the National Flag of India on 22nd August, 1907 in the International Socialist Conference held in Stuttgart, a city in Germany.

74. Consider the following statements :

- 1. The fundamental right to protection of life and personal liberty cannot be suspended during Emergency.
- 2. The Vice-President of India can be removed from the office by a resolution passed by the Council of States and approved by the House of the People.
- 3. At present the leader of opposition in the Council of States is Shri Arun Jaitley.
- 4. The Chairman of the Planning Commission of India is Shri Montek Singh Ahluwalia:

Code :

- (a) Only 1 and 2 are correct.
- (b) Only 2 and 3 are correct.
- (c) Only 3 and 4 are correct.
- (d) Only 1, 2 and 3 are correct.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

In the question period, Montek Singh Ahluwalia was the Deputy Chairman of Planning Commission. The Chairman of the Planning Commission is the Prime Minister. NITI Aayog was established in place of Planning commission on January 1, 2015. In the question period leader of the opposition in the Rajya Sabha was Arun Jaitley, but currently the Leader of the opposition in the Rajya Sabha is Mallikarjun Kharge. Option (a) is correct from current perspective.

75. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) Supreme Court is the highest court of appeal in India.
- (b) The number of languages recognized as regional languages in the Constitution of India is 18.
- (c) Article 35 read with Article 17 confers on the Parliament the power to make a law prescribing punishment for practicing untouchability.
- (d) The Charter Act of 1813 is termed as 'Magna Carta' of Indian liberties.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (*)

Under 92nd Constitutional Amendment 2003, the four languages Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, and Santhali were added in the 8th Schedule of the Indian Constitution. As a result of this Amendment, the total number of languages given in 8th Schedule became 22. There were 14 languages in 8th Schedule when the Constitution was enforced in 1950. The manifesto declared by Empress Victoria on November 1, 1858 is known as the 'Magna Carta' of Indian liberties. So option (b) and (d) both are incorrect.

76. Which among the following is/are correct :

High Courts hold their office till the age of 62 years.

2. A political party, which has been recognized in four or more states, is national party.

3. The speaker of the Lok Sabha decides whether a Bills is a Money Bill or not.

4. Cognizable offence is an offence, for which one can be arrested without any warrant.

(a) 1 and 2

(b) 1 and 3

(c) 3 and 4

(d) 1,2,3 and 4

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

According to Article 217(1) of the Constitution of India, a Judge of the High Court can hold his office till the age of 62 years. The Election Commission has provided the rule that only that political party can be considered as a National Party which has the recognition in at least 4 or more States in the country. According to the Article 110(3) of the Constitution, the speaker of the Lok Sabha can authenticate which bill brought before the House is a money bill. A cognizable offence is an offence for which a person can be arrested without a warrant.

77. What is that crime, which when tried is punishable, but when done the culprit crime doer cannot be punished?

(a) Murder

(b) Theft

(c) Suicide

(d) Rape

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

When the question was asked Suicide was a crime. Suicide was such a crime which if done, the culprit is not available for punishment. Although it's attempt was punishable earlier under section 309 of IPC. But Law Commission of India in its 210th report recommended deleting Section 309 of I.P.C. and which was supported by 18 states and 4 Union Territory to delete Section 309 of IPC from the statute book.

78. What is true about gallantry award 'Param Vir Chakra'?

(a) This award can be given to an individual only once in his/her lifetime

(b) On its medal, four replicas of 'Indra Vajra' are embossed

(c) Till 31st December, 2021, 25 people have been awarded with Param Vir Chakra

(d) This award was instituted on 26th January, 1952

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The Param Vir Chakra is India's highest military decoration. The medal was instituted on 26th January, 1950. On its medal, four replicas of 'Indra Vajra' are embossed. This award can be given to individual once or more than once in his/her lifetime. Till 31st December, 2021, only 21 people have been awarded with Param Vir Chakra.

79. Consider the following statements in respect of Bharat Ratna and Padma Awards :

1. Bharat Ratna and Padma Awards are titles under the Article 18(1) of the Constitution of India.

2. Padma Awards, which were instituted in the year 1954, were suspended only once.

3. The number of Bharat Ratna Awards is restricted to a maximum of five in a particular year.

Which of the above statements are not correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The conferment of titles of "Bharat Ratna", "Padma Vibhushan", "Padma Shri", etc. are said to be not prohibited under Article 18 as they merely denote State recognition of good work by citizens in the various fields of activity. Padma Awards, which were instituted in the year 1954, is announced every year on the occasion of Republic Day except for brief interruption during the years 1978 to 1979 and 1993 to 1997.

Bharat Ratna is the highest civilian award of the country. It is awarded in recognition of exceptional service/performance of the highest order in any field of human endeavour. It is treated on a different footing from Padma Award. The recommendations for Bharat Ratna are made by the Prime Minister to the President of India. No formal recommendations for Bharat Ratna are necessary. The number of Bharat Ratna Awards is restricted to a maximum of three in a particular year.

80. Who among the following is the recipient of Bharat Ratna for 2024 ?

(a) C. N. R. Rao

(b) M. S. Swaminathan

(c) Chandra Shekhar

(d) Pranab Mukharjee

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (b)

On February 9, 2024, the government announced that the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian award, would be conferred upon former Prime Ministers P.V. Narasimha Rao and Chaudhary Charan Singh, along with agricultural scientist M.S. Swaminathan (All posthumously). Prior to this, on February 3, 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, through a 'tweet', announced that the Bharat Ratna would be awarded to the senior leader of the BJP, L.K. Advani. Additionally, on January 23, 2024, the former Chief Minister of Bihar, Karpuri Thakur, was also announced to be posthumously awarded the Bharat Ratna. This year, a total of five people were honored with the Bharat Ratna, of which four were posthumous awards. L.K. Advani was awarded at his residence on 31 March 2024, the rest four were awarded on 30 March, 2024 at the Rashtrapati Bhawan.

81. Who was among following to receive first Bharat Ratna ?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Jawahar lal Nehru
(c) Lal Bahadur Shastri (d) S. Radhakrishnan
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (d)

The provision of Bharat Ratna was introduced in 1954. Chakravarti Rajagopalachari, Dr. Sarvepalli Radha Krishnan and C.V. Raman were awarded Bharat Ratna in 1954. Thus, option (d) is the correct answer.

82. At present, the highest Civilian award of the 'Republic of India' is—

- (a) Padma Vibhushan (b) Padma Bhushan
(c) Padma Shri (d) Bharat Ratna

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

At present, the highest Civilian award of the 'Republic of India' is 'Bharat Ratna'. The Government of India instituted two civilian awards—Bharat Ratna and Padma Vibhushan in 1954.

83. Which institution in India has been selected for Gandhi Peace Award 2021 ?

- (a) Geeta press, Gorakhpur
(b) Sulabh International
(c) Vivekanand Kendra, Kanyakumari
(d) Ram Krishna Mission
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The Gandhi Peace Prize for the year 2021 was conferred to Gita Press, Gorakhpur. Gandhi Peace Prize is an annual award instituted by the Government of India in 1995, on the occasion of 125th Birth Anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi as a tribute to the ideals espoused by Mahatma Gandhi. The award is open to all persons regardless of nationality, race, language, caste, creed or gender. The award carries an amount of Rs. 1 crore, a citation, a plaque and an exquisite traditional handicraft/handloom item. Gita Press, established in 1923, is one of the world's largest publishers, having published 41.7 crore books in 14 languages.

84. Match the following lists:

List-X	List-Y
(Outstanding Parliamentarian)	(Year of Award)
A. Arun Jaitley	(i) 2009
B. Karan Singh	(ii) 2012
C. Sharad Yadav	(iii) 2011
D. Murli Manohar Joshi	(iv) 2010

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	iv	iii	ii	i
(b)	iii	iv	ii	i
(c)	i	ii	iii	iv
(d)	ii	i	iii	iv

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The outstanding Parliamentarian Award is given by the Indian Parliamentary Group to an outstanding sitting Member of the Indian Parliament for overall contribution in the Indian Parliament. It was instituted in 1995. Dr. Murli Manohar Joshi in 2009, Arun Jaitley in 2010, Karn Sing in 2011 and Sharad Yadav received the award in 2012.

85. Which among the following States has record of formation of maximum Coalition Governments between 1967 to 1971?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Haryana
(c) Bihar (d) Punjab

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Record nine coalition governments were formed in Bihar between 1967 to 1971.

86. Who among the following is the first Indian transgender Judge?

- (a) Sadhna Sharma, Chhattisgarh
(b) Chitra Barucha, Tamil Nadu

- (c) Oman Kutty, Kerala
(d) Joyita Mondal, West Bengal

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

Joyita Mondal is the first transgender Judge of a Lok Adalat and a social worker from West Bengal.

29 year old Mondal became the first transgender Judge of a Lok Adalat from West Bengal. She attended as a Judge of a Lok Adalat at Islampur in North Dinajpur.

87. The Press Council of India is a –

- (a) Statutory Body
(b) Statutory Quasi-judicial Body
(c) Judicial Body
(d) Advisory Body

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

The Press Council of India is a Statutory Quasi-Judicial body which was established in 1966 under the Indian press council Act, 1965.

88. Who is the Chairman of the Press Council of India ?

- (a) P.L. Punia (b) Markandeya Katju
(c) Kuldeep Nayar (d) Puja Bhatt

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

The retired Judge of the Supreme Court, Justice Markandey Katju was appointed as the Chairman of the Press Council of India on October 5, 2011 for a period of 3 years. Currently, Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai is the Chairman of the Council.

89. Which of the following is a reason of emergence of regionalism in India?

- (a) Uneven development
(b) Fear of losing cultural identity
(c) Political prominence
(d) All the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

The emergence of regionalism in India has various causes, like unbalanced development in different regions, fear of losing cultural identity and the greed to gain political prominence.

90. The National Water Development Agency was established in the year –

- (a) 1982 (b) 1986
(c) 1991 (d) 1997

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

National Water Development Agency (NWDA) was set up in July, 1982 as an autonomous society under the Societies Registration Act, 1860 to carry out water balance and other studies on a scientific basis for optimum utilization of water resources. The government of India constituted National Water Board in September, 1990.

91. Which is the correct chronological order of the following?

1. Shimla Agreement
2. Indo-Soviet Treaty
3. Farakka Accord
4. Tashkent Agreement

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code:

- (a) 4, 2, 1, 3 (b) 3, 2, 1, 4
(c) 2, 3, 4, 1 (d) 1, 2, 3, 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (a)

The Shimla Agreement on 2 July, 1972 was signed between India and Pakistan. Indo-Soviet Treaty is a pact for friendship and cooperation between India and the Soviet Union on signed on August 9, 1971. The Farakka Accord between India and Bangladesh was signed in 1977 temporarily and finally on 12th December, 1996 and Tashkent Agreement with Pakistan was signed on 10th January, 1966. Therefore, chronologically option (a) is correct.

92. Bangladesh was created as a result of Indo-Pak hostilities in -

- (a) December, 1971 (b) January, 1972
(c) February, 1972 (d) November, 1971

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

On 3 December, 1971 India intervened on behalf of Bangladeshi refugees who migrated to Indian side due to oppressive measures adopted in East Pakistan to suppress protest marches following Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's arrest in western Pakistan. On 16 December, 1971 Pakistani Army unconditionally surrendered, and therefore Eastern Pakistan became a free Nation named as Bangladesh, and Sheikh Mujibur Rahman became its first Prime Minister.

93. Who is the founder of terrorist group Lashkar-e-Taiba?

- (a) Maulana Masood (b) Hafiz Muhammad Saeed
(c) Umar Abdulla (d) Osama Bin Laden

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

Lashkar-e-Taiba is an active terrorist organization in South Asia. It was founded by Hafiz Muhammad Saeed, Zafar Iqbal and Mahmoud Mohammad Bahaziq in 1990 at Kunar Province of Afghanistan.

94. Which of the following countries have banned LTTE?

- (a) India, Sri Lanka, France
- (b) India, Sri Lanka, U.S.A.
- (c) Sri Lanka, Nepal, India
- (d) Sri Lanka, Nepal, Maldives

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

India, Sri Lanka and the United States, including many other countries of the world have banned the LTTE. In 2009 the Sri Lankan Army launched a massive operation against LTTE, in which its chief B. Prabhakaran was killed.

95. 'Djibouti' Code of Conduct is related to:

- (a) Conservation of Congo basin
- (b) International Maritime grouping against piracy
- (c) Charter of ethics
- (d) Principles for conducting nuclear test

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Djibouti Code of conduct is related to International Maritime grouping against Piracy. It is also known as the code of conduct concerning the repression of Piracy and Armed Robbery against ships in the Western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden. It was adopted on 29th January, 2009.

96. Match the following -

- | | |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|
| A. Operation Checkmate | 1. Maldives |
| B. Operation Cactus | 2. Punjab |
| C. Operation Blue Star | 3. Bihar |
| D. Operation Siddharth | 4. Sri Lanka |

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (b) | 4 | 1 | 3 | 2 |
| (c) | 4 | 2 | 3 | 1 |
| (d) | 1 | 4 | 3 | 2 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows :
 Operation Checkmate- Sri Lanka
 Operation Cactus- Maldives
 Operation Blue Star - Punjab
 Operation Siddharth - Bihar

97. "Bahujan Hitaya, Bahujan Sukhaya" is the motto of :

- (a) All India Radio
- (b) Doordarshan
- (c) Life Insurance Corporation of India
- (d) General Insurance Corporation of India

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

"Bahujan Hitaya, Bahujan Sukhaya" is the motto of All India Radio.

98. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- (a) Apico Aandolan - P. Hegde
- (b) Chipco Aandolan - S.L. Bahuguna
- (c) Narmada Bachao Andolan - Medha Patkar
- (d) Silent Valley Aandolan - Baba Aamte

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (d)

Baba Aamte was associated with the conservation of Wildlife and Narmada Bachao, but in the context of Silent Valley Movement, Dr. Salim Ali's name remained in the limelight.

99. To whom the Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) is military advisor on Tri-services matters?

- (a) President of India
- (b) Prime Minister of India
- (c) Defence Minister of India
- (d) Home Minister of India

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Chief of Defence Staff is military advisor to Defence Minister of India on Tri-Service matters. The first CDS Late General Bipin Rawat took office on 1 January, 2020 and Incumbent CDS is General Anil Chauhan.

100. What is not true in reference to Chief of Defence Staff?

- (a) Maximum age limit for this post is 65 years
- (b) He is permanent Chairman of Chief of Staff Committee
- (c) He is Chairman of Defence Acquisition Council
- (d) He is member of Defence Planning Committee

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The maximum age limit to Chief of Defence Staff post is 65 years. He is permanent Chairman of Chief of Staff Committee and he is member of Defence Planning Committee. However Defence Minister is Chairman of Defence Acquisition Council and National Security Advisor (NSA) is Chairman of Defence Planning Committee.

101. What are the duties of the Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) as Head of the Department of Military Affairs?

1. Permanent Chairman of Chiefs of Staff Committee
2. Exercise military command over the three Service Chiefs
3. Principal Military Advisor to Defence Minister on all tri-service matters

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) is the Head of the Department of Military Affairs in Ministry of Defence and function as its Secretary. He is the Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee and acts as the Principal Military Advisor to Defence Minister on all tri-service matters so as to provide impartial advice to the political leadership. Hence, statements 1 and 3 are correct.

The duties and functions of the Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) include administering the tri-service organizations/agencies/commands and to bring about jointness in operation, logistics, transport, training, support services, communications, repairs and maintenance, etc. of the three Services. But the CDS does not exercise military command over the three Service Chiefs. Each Service Chief retains operational command over their respective Service. Hence, statement 2 is Incorrect.

102. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Southern Air-Command- Thiruvananthapuram
(b) Eastern Naval Command - Vishakhapatnam
(c) Armoured Corps Centre and School- Jabalpur
(d) Army Medical Centre and School - Lucknow

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Armoured Corps Centre and School is situated in Ahmednagar, Maharashtra not in Jabalpur (M.P.) So the pair in option (c) is incorrect while the remaining others are correctly matched.

103. The number of operational commands of the Indian Army is (as of June 1999) -

- (a) 5 (b) 4
(c) 6 (d) 7

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

The operational commands of Indian Army as of June 1999, were 5 which are 6 at present. These are as follows:

Command	Headquarter
Western Command	Chandi Mandir, Chandigarh
Eastern Command	Kolkata
Northern Command	Udhampur (J & K)
Southern Command	Pune
Central Command	Lucknow
South Western Command	Jaipur (functional from August 15, 2005)

Apart from this the headquarter of training command is in Shimla.

104. Which of the following is/are correctly matched in terms of equivalent rank in the three services of Indian Defence forces?

	Army	Airforce	Navy
1.	Brigadier	Air Commodore	Commander
2.	Major General	Air Vice Marshal	Vice Admiral
3.	Major	Squadron Leader	Lieutenant Commander
4.	Lieutenant Colonel	Group Captain	Captain

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 4 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 3 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Army, Navy, and Air Force are the three major defence services in India. The commissioned officers and personnel below officers working in these Indian Defence forces enjoy ranks that are equal to one another. Here are some equivalent ranks in the Indian Army, Navy, and Airforce:

- Field Marshal in the Army: Equivalent to Marshal of the Airforce and Admiral of the fleet in the Navy
- General in the Army: Equivalent to Air Chief Marshal in the Airforce and Admiral in the Navy
- Lieutenant General in the Army: Equivalent to Air Marshal in the Airforce and Vice Admiral in the Navy
- Major General in the Army: Equivalent to Air Vice Marshal in the Airforce and Rear Admiral in the Navy
- Brigadier in the Army: Equivalent to Air Commodore in the Airforce and Commodore in the Navy

- Colonel in the Army: Equivalent to Group Captain in the Airforce and Captain in the Navy
 - Lieutenant Colonel in the Army: Equivalent to Wing Commander in the Airforce and Commander in the Navy
 - Major in the Army: Equivalent to Squadron Leader in the Airforce and Lieutenant Commander in the Navy
 - Captain in the Army: Equivalent to Flight Lieutenant in the Airforce and Lieutenant in the Navy
 - Lieutenant in the Army: Equivalent to Flying Officer in the Airforce and Sub Lieutenant in the Navy
- Hence, only row 3 is correctly matched.

105. In Indian Navy, the equivalent of an army lieutenant colonel is:

- (a) Commodore (b) Captain
(c) Commander (d) Lieutenant Commander

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

The different ranks of the Indian Army are as follows –

Indian Army	Indian Navy	Indian Air Force
General	Admiral	Air Chief Marshal
Lieutenant General	Vice-Admiral	Air Marshal
Major General	Rear Admiral	Air Vice Marshal
Brigadier	Commodore	Air Commodore
Colonel	Captain	Group Captain
Lieutenant Colonel	Commander	Wing Commander
Major	Lieutenant Commander	Squadron Leader
Captain	Lieutenant	Flight Lieutenant
Lieutenant	Sub-Lieutenant	Flying Officer

106. Operations undertaken by the Army towards upliftment of the local population in remote areas to include addressing of their basic needs is called:

- (a) Operation Sankalp (b) Operation Maitri
(c) Operation Sadbhavana (d) Operation Madad

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

Operations undertaken by the Army towards upliftment of the local population in remote areas to include addressing of their basic needs is called "Operation Sadbhavana". The core concept of Operation Sadbhavana is that "human security is the key element of national security, which can only be ensured through human resource and infrastructure development". Accordingly, Operation Sadbhavana

initiatives have focussed on infrastructure development/improvement, quality education, women empowerment, health care, community development, integration tours and sports. As part of Operation Sadbhavana, Indian Army is undertaking multiple welfare activities in remote areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Sikkim etc.

107. Border Security Force came into existence in -

- (a) 1965 (b) 1970
(c) 1910 (d) 1950

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The Border Security Force was raised on 1 December, 1965. It is a specialized and centrally controlled security force which is armed and trained to man international Border with Pakistan. The headquarter of BSF is in Delhi.

108. Border Security Force (BSF) is responsible for guarding on borders of which countries?

- (a) Pakistan and Nepal
(b) Pakistan and Bhutan
(c) Pakistan and Bangladesh
(d) Pakistan and China

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) - 2018

Ans. (c)

The Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) commonly known as Paramilitary forces guard the six different international borders.

- (a) Border Security Force (BSF) - Indo-Pakistan & Indo-Bangladesh Border.
(b) Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) - Indo-China Border
(c) Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) - Indo-Nepal and Indo Bhutan
(d) Assam Rifles - Indo-China and Indo-Myanmar Border.

109. With reference to Home Guards, consider the following statements:

1. Home Guards are raised under the Home Guards Act and Rules of the Central Government.
2. The role of the Home Guards is to serve as an auxiliary force to the police in maintenance internal security.
3. To prevent infiltration on the international border/coastal areas, the Border Wing Home Guards Battalions have been raised in some States.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All three (d) None

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2023

Ans. (b)

Home Guards are a voluntary force to assist the police in controlling civil disturbance and communal riots. They are raised by the State governments under State Acts. Thus the Central Government does not directly raise Home Guards. Hence, Statement 1 is incorrect. In addition to assisting the police maintain internal security, home guards can also assist the community in times of emergency such as air raids, fires, cyclones, earthquakes, and epidemics. Various Border Wing Home Guards (BWHG) Battalions have been raised in the border States viz. Punjab, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Meghalaya, Tripura and West Bengal to serve as an auxiliary to Border Security Force for preventing infiltration on the international border/coastal areas. Hence Statement 2 and 3 are correct.

110. Internal Security Academy is located at –

- (a) Mount Abu (b) Nasik
(c) Hyderabad (d) Pune

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The Internal Security Academy was established under the aegis of Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India at Mount Abu (a hill station in the Aravali Range in Rajasthan).

111. The First Law University in India was established in August 1987 in –

- (a) Trivandrum (b) Ahmedabad
(c) Bangalore (d) New Delhi

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The First Law University-'National Law School of India' was established in August, 1987 in Bangalore.

112. The Law University was established in?

- (a) Kerala (b) Trivandrum
(c) New Delhi (d) Bangalore

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

There was not any law university in Kerala and New Delhi at time when question was asked. First Law University, known as National Law school of India, is located in Bengaluru. National Law University is in New Delhi; National University of advanced legal studies is situated in Kochi while there is no law university in Trivandrum.

113. Assertion (A) : Castes are being politicized in India.

Reason (R) : Casteism has been increasing in Indian Politics.

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Casteism has been increasing in Indian politics. Castes are emerging as pressure groups and being politicized in India. Thus, both assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

114. Which state gave the status of OBC to Gurkhas in 2003?

- (a) U.P. (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Maharashtra (d) Uttarakhand

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

In 2003, the State of Uttarakhand gave the Status of OBC (Other Backward Class) to the Gurkhas and 2 other communities Ghrit Chahang and Uthalia Vora.

115. Scientific socialism is attributed to

- (a) Karl Marx (b) Adam Smith
(c) J. M. Keynes (d) Thomas Mann

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Scientific Socialism is attributed to Karl Marx. Karl Marx provided scientific foundation to the idea of socialism. Karl Marx is also regarded as the father of communism.

116. How many types of Bureaucracy were given by Morstein Marx?

- (a) Two (b) Three
(c) Four (d) Five

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

Morstein Marx given four types Bureaucracy

- (1) Guardian Bureaucracy
(2) Caste Bureaucracy
(3) Patronage Bureaucracy
(4) Merit Bureaucracy

117. Who has authored 'Gandhian Constitution for Free India'?

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
(b) Achyut Patwardhan
(c) Shriman Narayan Agarwal
(d) Humayun Kabir

R.A.S./R.T.S (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The Gandhian Constitution of free India was published in 1946. Unlike the title suggests, M.K Gandhi did not write the document, Shriman Narayan Agarwal, a Gandhian economist, drafted it based on Gandhi's idea.

118. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from code given below :

List-I (Authors)		List-II (Books)
(A) Atul Kohli	–	Divide and Quit
(B) Granville Austin	–	The Success of India's Democracy
(C) Penderal Moon	–	The Republic of India : Development of its Laws and constitution
(D) Alan Gledhill	–	Working a Democratic : A History of the Indian Experience

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	(iii)	(iv)	(i)	(ii)
(b)	(ii)	(i)	(iii)	(iv)
(c)	(ii)	(iv)	(i)	(iii)
(d)	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The correct match is following -

Atul Kohli	(i)	The Success of India's Democracy
Granville Austin	(ii)	Working a Democratic : A History of the Indian Experience
Penderal Moon	(iii)	Divide and Quit
Alan Gledhill	(iv)	The Republic of India : Development of its Laws and constitution

119. Who is the author of the book : Democracy and Development in India from Socialism to Pro-Business ?

- (a) Partha Chatterjee (b) Atul Kohli
(c) Vishwanath Mishra (d) Myron Weiner

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Atul Kohli is the author of the book : Democracy and Development in India from Socialism to Pro-Business. It was published in 2009.

120. Where was the 'Festival of India' organized for the first time outside India?

- (a) Britain 1982 (b) France 1985
(c) America 1980 (d) Soviet Union 1983

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

For the first time the 'Festival of India' was organised outside India in Britain in 1982.

121. 'Prawasi Bharatiya Diwas' (PBD) or NRI Day is celebrated in India every year on which date?

- (a) January 19 (b) January 9
(c) January 11 (d) January 12

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

9 January commemorates the return of Mahatma Gandhi from South Africa to India in 1915. To mark this day, the tradition of celebrating Prawasi Bhartiya Divas (PBD) (NRI Day) started in 2003. First PBD Convention was organised on 9 January 2003 to mark the contribution of the overseas Indian community to the development of India. Since 2015, under a revised format, PBD convention has been organised once every 2 years. 17th PBD convention 2023 had the theme "Diaspora : Reliable Partners of India's Progress in Amrit kaal" 18th PBD convention was organised from 8-10 January 2025 with the theme - "Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat".

122. The Pravasi Bhartiya Divas (PBD) is organized in India to connect with a large number of Pravasis. This Convention began in the year –

- (a) 1991 (b) 2001
(c) 2003 (d) 2013

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (c)

The former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee on 8 January, 2002 on the basis of the report of Lakshminil Singhvi Committee declared that 'Pravasi Bhartiya Divas' will be celebrated on January 9, to commemorate the return of Mahatma Gandhi from South Africa. This convention is organized every year in India since 2003 to 2015 and after 2015 it became biennale. Pravasi Bhartiya Diwas was organised at Indore in the year 2023.

123. Who of the following is the author of the books 'The India Way' and 'Why Bharat Matters'?

- (a) Bhupender Yadav
(b) Nalin Mehta
(c) Shashi Tharoor
(d) Subrahmanyam Jaishankar

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, better known as S. Jaishankar, is an Indian diplomat, politician and author, who is currently serving as Minister of External Affairs of the Government of India. 'The India Way: Strategies for an Uncertain World' (2020) and 'Why Bharat Matters' (2024) are books authored by S. Jaishankar.

124. Which date is observed as the Good governance Day in India?

- (a) 14th November (b) 25th December
(c) 2nd October (d) 1st May

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

To mark and celebrate in the honour of the Former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee's birthday, India observes "Good Governance Day" on 25th December, every year since, It was announced in the year 2014.

125. Who has started the Har Ghar Tiranga Abhiyan on the occasion of India's 75th Independence Day?

- (a) Election Commission (b) NITI Aayog
(c) Indian Army (d) Central Government
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2022

Ans. (d)

On the occasion of the 75th anniversary of the country Har Ghar Tiranga Abhiyan was launched by the Central Government under the aegis of 'Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav'. The official journey of Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav commenced on 12th March, 2021 which started a 75 week countdown to our 75th anniversary of independence and ended post a year on 15th August, 2023.

126. Consider the following pairs:

	Country	Reason for being in the news
1.	Argentina	Worst economic crisis
2.	Sudan	War between the country's regular army and paramilitary forces
3.	Turkey	Rescinded its membership of NATO

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one pair (b) Only two pairs
(c) All three pairs (d) None of the pairs

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

With one of the world's highest inflation rates and after more than a decade of economic stagnation and rising poverty, Argentina once again finds itself teetering on the brink of economic collapse. The urgent need for a plan to stabilise the economy has entrusted the newly elected President Javier Milei (Assumed office on 10 December, 2023) with a clear mandate: eradicate inflation and reignite economic growth. The deep-rooted cause of Argentina's economic distress and chronic inflation is persistent public overspending financed by money creation. Hence, pair 1 is correctly matched.

A civil war between two major rival factions of the military government of Sudan, the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) under Abdel Fattah al-Burhan and the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) and its allies (collectively the Janjaweed coalition) under the Janjaweed leader Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo 'Hemedti', began during Ramadan on 15

April, 2023. The conflict has caused widespread devastation, with thousands of civilians killed and millions displaced. The conflict traces back to April 2019, when Sudan's long-serving President Omar al-Bashir was overthrown by military generals following a nationwide uprising. Hence, pair 2 is correctly matched.

NATO was established in 1949 and Turkey (Türkiye) joined NATO in 1952. Turkey's role within NATO constantly increased since the end of the Cold War. All NATO members need to approve applications from countries seeking to join the alliance. When Sweden and Finland asked to join in 2022, Turkey raised objections. In January 2024, Turkey finally backed Sweden's NATO bid for its inclusion. Turkey has not rescinded its membership of NATO. Hence, pair 3 is not correctly matched.

127. Consider the following pairs:

Region often in news	Country
1. Chechnya	: Russian Federation
2. Darfur	: Mali
3. Swat Valley	: Iraq

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Chechnya is located in the North Caucasus Russia, situated in the most southern part of Eastern Europe, and 100 kilometers away from the Caspian Sea. Darfur is a region situated in Western Sudan. Therefore pair (2) is not correctly matched. Swat is a river valley and an administrative district in the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Province of Pakistan. It is the upper valley of the Swat River, which rises in the Hindu Kush range. Therefore, pair (3) is also not correctly matched.

128. The Berber-speaking community which often happens to be in the limelight, lives in –

- (a) Afghanistan (b) Algeria
(c) Argentina (d) Australia

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

The Berber-speaking community speaks completely different language than Arabic. They live in North African countries like Morocco and Algeria. They are also known as Amazigh, original inhabitants of the region.

129. Consider the following countries:

1. Denmark 2. Japan
3. Russian Federation 4. United Kingdom
5. United States of America

Which of the above are the members of the 'Arctic Council'?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4

(c) 1, 4 and 5

(d) 1, 3 and 5

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

The Arctic Council was established by Ottawa Declaration in 1996. The Arctic Council is the pre-eminent inter-governmental forum for addressing issues related to the Arctic Region. The members of the Arctic Council include eight countries, Canada, Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, the Russian Federation, and the United States. The Council provides a means for promoting cooperation, coordination and interaction among the Arctic States, with the involvement of the Arctic indigenous communities and other Arctic inhabitants on common Arctic issues, in particular issues of sustainable development and environmental protection in the Arctic. India and Japan are also included in 12 permanent supervisors of this Council. The chairmanship of this council changes after every two years. Iceland is the chairman of the council from 2019 to 2021.

130. Which of the following was not included in India- Sri Lanka Accord -

- (a) Formation of a new State by merging eastern and northern provinces
- (b) Establishment of North East Council
- (c) Complete Freedom
- (d) Integrity of Sri Lanka

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (c)

Maintenance of the integrity of Sri Lanka was a part of India-Sri Lanka Accord, 1987. Complete freedom for Tamil-State was not mentioned in the accord.

131. Who was the first woman to become the Prime Minister of any country?

- (a) Sirimavo Bhandarnaike
- (b) Margaret Thatcher
- (c) Golda Meir
- (d) Indira Gandhi

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

Sirimavo Bandaranaike was a Sri Lankan politician and the first woman to become the Prime Minister of any Country. She became the Prime Minister of Sri Lanka in 1960. She was sworn-in as Prime Minister of Sri Lanka three times, 1960–65, 1970–77 and 1994–2000.

132. Which among the following European Union countries is the first to officially recognize the State of Palestine?

- (a) Sweden
- (b) Denmark
- (c) Norway
- (d) Italy

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Sweden is the first European Union country which officially recognised the State of Palestine in October, 2014. On 30 September, 2015, the Palestinian Flag was raised outside the UN Headquarter for the first time.

133. UN observed _____ as International year for Women.

- (a) 1975
- (b) 1976
- (c) 1977
- (d) 1972

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

UN observed the year 1975 as the International Year for Women.

134. The International Day of Persons with Disabilities is celebrated on

- (a) 10th December
- (b) 24th October
- (c) 19th November
- (d) 3rd December

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The International Day of Persons with Disabilities is celebrated every year on 3rd December. Since 1992, International Day of Persons with Disabilities has been celebrated annually on 3 December.

135. International Day of Non-violence is observed on:

- (a) 10th December
- (b) 30th January
- (c) 2nd October
- (d) 23rd March

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The International Day of Non-violence is observed on 2nd October, the birthday of Mahatma Gandhi, leader of the Indian Independence Movement and pioneer of the philosophy and strategy of non-violence. By a resolution on 15 June, 2007 the United Nations General Assembly determined to celebrate 2nd October as the International Day of Non-Violence.

136. 'ULFA' extremist are related to which state:

- (a) Assam
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Punjab
- (d) Jammu and Kashmir

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

The United Liberation Front of Assam (ULFA) is a separatist outfit operating in Assam. It was founded on 7 April, 1979. It seeks to establish a Sovereign Assam via an armed struggle. This organization was banned by the Government in 1990.

137. 'People's War Group' a terrorist organization is based in-

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Assam
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

'People's War Group' was established by Kondapalli Seetharamaiah on 22 April, 1980 in Andhra Pradesh.